雨前漫游
[English text unavailable]

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【3.1】雨前漫游 01

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拉普拉斯研究员： 77 114 46 32 85 108 114 105 99 104?

Laplace Researcher: 77 114 46 32 85 108 114 105 99 104?

拉普拉斯研究员： 84 104 101 114 101 39 115 32 97 32 102 111 120 32 104 101 114 101 32 116 111 32 115 101 101 32 121 111 117。

Laplace Researcher: 84 104 101 114 101 39 115 32 97 32 102 111 120 32 104 101 114 101 32 116 111 32 115 101 101 32 121 111 117.

房间里的人比研究员以为的要多。

The researcher steps into the room, surprised to see so many people inside.

他礼貌地向哑谜、冷周六、兔毛手袋三位同僚，总跟在星锑研究员后头的 APPLe 先生，以及一位佩戴基金会徽章的小姐点头致意，然后等待乌尔里希组长的回复。

He gives polite nods to them—Enigma, Hissabeth, Medicine Pocket, Mr. APPLe, though not a researcher himself, always at Regulus's side, and a woman wearing a Foundation badge—then waits quietly for Ulrich to respond.

正埋头于一叠报告的磁流体抬起头。

Ulrich looks up from his stack of reports.

乌尔里希： ……什么?

Ulrich: ... Pardon?

拉普拉斯研究员： 79104!

Laplace Researcher: 79104!

研究员仿佛才想起来什么一般，从口袋里掏出一个机器，对着它将那几串冗长的数字又重复了一遍。

The researcher's eyes widen for a moment, then he quickly pulls a device from his pocket and recites a string of long numbers into it.

乌尔里希： ……

Ulrich: ...

所有人等待着。几秒后，那个小小的金属盒子里响起了合成人声。

After a short pause, an artificial voice speaks from the device.

转译器： 抱歉，乌尔里希组长，我忘了开转译器——有个奇怪的狐狸头想要找你。

Translator: Sorry, Mr. Ulrich. I forgot to switch the translator on. There's a strange fox-headed character asking for you.

乌尔里希： 噢，没事，我本来该反应过来你说的是十进制，但我正在看一篇八进制的报告……

Ulrich: Oh no, it was my mistake. Damn report's got me stuck thinking in octal. I didn't realize you were using decimal.

乌尔里希摆了摆手，像是要把数字们从眼前挥开。

Ulrich gives a wave of his hand, as if brushing the numbers away.

乌尔里希： 是缪斯三世来了，我们马上过去。

Ulrich: Must be Musae III. We're on our way.

讲着奇怪编码的研究员离开了。

The code-speaking researcher leaves the room.

房间里的黑发男人在这场对话刚开始时就面露讥讽，而现在显然是一个不必再克制的好时机。

Enigma, who had maintained a mocking expression through the whole scene, now sees no reason to hold back his thoughts any longer.

哑谜： 三分钟，真惊人。多亏了你在玩具箱里的人文关怀，现在我们的交流效率堪比猿猴。也许再过一星期我们就能抛弃无意义的喊叫，进化到用壁画记事了。
Enigma: Three minutes. Remarkable. Thanks to your "great compassion" in the toybox, we're now communicating as efficiently as early primates. At this rate, we might graduate from meaningless shouting to cave paintings within the week.

乌尔里希： 这和我的人文关怀没有一点关系。
Ulrich: Let's get one thing straight. This has nothing to do with my humanitarian efforts.

磁流体恼怒地闪烁了一下，再次驳回了自它回归以来哑谜对它反复提出的指控。
The ferrofluid flickers with irritation as he is forced once again to brush off the same accusations Enigma has been throwing at him since his return.

乌尔里希： 事实上，如果不是我打开了沙滩里的密码锁，我们根本发现不了玩具箱出了问题，更不知道这该死的语言异化症来自哪儿。
Ulrich: In fact, if I hadn't cracked that lock on the beach, we'd still have no clue about the toybox malfunction, let alone where this damn language disorder came from.

本不该在房间里的两位研究员彼此交换了一个眼色。
Two researchers, who clearly have no real reason to be in the room, exchange a glance.

很明显，比起和实验室里满口数字字母的同僚共事，他们更乐意参与到眼前的“项目”中来。
Clearly, they'd rather be involved in this "project" than stuck trying to communicate with colleagues who only speak in numbers and codes.

兔毛手袋： 这是第几次了？
Medicine Pocket: Ugh, not this again.

冷周六： 算上他俩刚从玩具箱出来时的那回吵架？第八次。嘘。
Hissabeth: If we count that fight right after they came out of the toybox, this makes it the eighth time. Just stay quiet and enjoy.

哑谜： 或者，如果你专注你的项目，别管那些棋子发生了什么，就能及时在玩具箱带来乱子前把它还给狐狸。
Enigma: Maybe if you'd focused on the actual project instead of worrying about those pieces,

哑谜： 而不是像现在这样，让魔盒里的绝望跑得到处都是，“潘多拉”先生。
Enigma: you could've returned the toybox before it unleashed all its miseries on the world, Mr. Pandora.

乌尔里希： 别开玩笑了！语言异化症蔓延的速度快得离谱——
Ulrich: Quit joking around! The language disorder is getting worse by the hour.

乌尔里希： 刚刚那个来通知的欧文还能听懂英语，汉娜从昨天下午开始就变得只能理解希尔密码的符号。你如何断言状况不会发生？
Ulrich: Owen—the one who brought the message just now—still understands English, but Hannah's only been able to read Hill cipher symbols since yesterday afternoon. How can you be so sure it's not going to get worse?

哑谜： 把你沉迷过家家游戏的时间刨除，完成“暴雨”前演练的总时长可以缩减至少三成。
Enigma: If you'd just stop wasting time on those silly simulations, we could shorten the Pre-Storm Protocol by at least thirty percent.

哑谜： 假设你的玻璃脑袋还没被编码语言搞坏——
Enigma: Assuming all the coded language swimming around in that glass tank of yours hasn't completely scrambled your circuits!

乌尔里希：假设你不是只会挖苦，而是有哪怕一点真正的作用——
Ulrich: Assuming YOU'RE capable of being useful for once rather than only throwing out smug comments!

一场再次发生的争论。在升级为更激烈的争吵前，它被一个细弱却不容忽视的声音打断了。
Another argument breaks out, but before it can go any further, a quiet yet steady voice speaks up.

马库斯：先生……先生们……
Marcus: Sir ... Sirs ...

马库斯：抱歉打断您，但是……语言异化症?
Marcus: I hate to interrupt, but did you say language disorder?

磁流体转过身，努力平缓自己的剧烈波动，并无视了一旁蛇发女妖那明显带有遗憾意味的叹息。
Ulrich turns away, struggling to steady his turbulent emotions, pretending he doesn't hear Hissabeth heave a regretful sigh.

乌尔里希：是的，马库斯小姐。如你所见，拉普拉斯从四天前开始陷入了一场语言混乱，二进制编码、摩斯电码、栅栏密码……几乎所有人都开始用奇怪的符号系统讲话。
Ulrich: Correct, Ms. Marcus. For the last four days, communication at Laplace has completely broken down. People are speaking in binary code, Morse code, even rail fence cipher. Almost everyone has switched to encrypted languages.

乌尔里希：我们推测这一切和用于模拟雨前演练的玩具箱有关。
Ulrich: We think it's linked to the toybox we've been using for our Pre-Storm Protocol stimulations.

乌尔里希：一周前缪斯三世检查箱子时提到了有东西失窃，这之后，语言异化症就从箱子所在的楼层开始迅速蔓延……并且仍没有停止的迹象。
Ulrich: During the inspection last week, Musae III mentioned something was stolen. After that, the language disorder started spreading fast from the floor we keep the toybox on, and it hasn't let up since.

乌尔里希：虽然这一情况目前尚无其他异变，除了沟通效率之外也暂未造成其他影响，但……
Ulrich: While we haven't seen any other effects beyond the communication problems so far ...

女孩儿的神情紧张起来。
Marcus looks nervous.

马库斯：您担心……它可能会引起时代的混乱……?
Marcus: Are you concerned this could ... cause time disturbances?

冷周六：不不不，放松些，没那么严重，应该不会引起一次室内“暴雨”。
Hissabeth: Oh please, don't panic. It's not going to trigger a "Storm" inside Laplace or anything.

冷周六：但它绝对会引起拉普拉斯每周例会、实验室经费申请、以及员工食堂自助选餐的混乱。
Hissabeth: But it will absolutely wreck our weekly briefings, lab funding applications, and the canteen's ordering system.

冷周六：换言之，引起拉普拉斯全部日程的混乱。
Hissabeth: In other words, it'll throw off Laplace's whole schedule.

马库斯：嗯……可是，我怎样才能帮上您的忙？我不懂密码，也不擅长数学……
Marcus: I'm just wondering ... how can I help? Codes and math aren't really my strengths ...

哑谜：上一次，你从那个“奇迹的魔圈”里听写出了那份咒文，对吧?
Enigma: Didn't you manage to write down that incantation from "The Circle"?

哑谜：突破了状态与形式的隔阂，直接对目标进行解读……这是你的神秘术?
Enigma: You were able to push past physical barriers and understand the real meaning directly. That's your arcane skill, isn't it?

乌尔里希： 这次也是和语言有关的谜题。我认为，既然普通的信息沟通出现障碍，你也许能从书页上阅读出额外的信息。
Ulrich: Our current issue is also about language, mathematical as it may be. Your skills in picking out hidden messages might just be exactly what we need.

马库斯： 我明白了，我会尽我所能——
Marcus: Understood. I'll do the best I can.

或许是阿德勒研究员的衬托，如此平和流畅的交流让乌尔里希赞许地点点头。
Ulrich gives a small nod, pleased to see even a brief moment of calm, focused discussion.

乌尔里希： 缪斯三世已经在确认相关情况了，走吧，我们得去敲定后续的行动方案。
Ulrich: Musae III is already looking into it. Let's go; we need to confirm our next steps.

缪斯三世： 我会持续维护玩具箱，尽力抑制语言污染的扩散，与此同时——真抱歉，恐怕得请你们再进到玩具箱里去。
Musae III: I'll keep working to fix the toybox and try my best to slow down the language corruption. But ... I'm afraid I'll have to ask you to go back inside it again.

哑谜： 还来?
Enigma: You can't be serious.

黑头发研究员狠狠瞪着双头狐狸玩偶，语气里充满了不可置信。
Enigma glares at the two-headed fox plushie, his voice brimming with disbelief.

缪斯三世： 这次不太一样，朋友们。
Musae III: This time it's different, my friends.

缪斯三世： 玩具箱的核心不翼而飞，但并没有“飞”远。我确信它还在箱子里，只是不在它原本该在的地方。
Musae III: The core of the toybox is gone, yes, but it hasn't left the system. I'm certain it's still in there somewhere, just not where it should be.

缪斯三世： 90% 以上的可能性，核心位于玩具箱程序层——也就是玩具箱的更下层。
Musae III: There's a high chance—higher than ninety percent—that it's moved to the program layer, and that means it's deeper inside the toybox.

哑谜： 先等会儿，狐狸，你最好说清楚，我们到底要找什么？一个棋子，一枚零件?
Enigma: Wait a second, whiskers. Be clear—what exactly are we supposed to find? A piece? A component?

缪斯三世： 喔……这正是难点所在。我很难给你描述它的样子。
Musae III: Well ... that's the tricky part. I don't really know how to describe what it looks like.

缪斯三世： 根据我检查的结果来看，箱内的认知系统已经紊乱，也就是说，它或许没有能被稳定识别的形态……
Musae III: From what I can tell, the toybox's cognitive systems aren't functioning as they should. Simply put, it might not have a fixed or familiar shape now.

缪斯三世： 但别沮丧，您瞧，就像被污染的语言仍发挥语言功能，这枚核心也必然还保留着它维持认知的特性，也许您会发现，它的形态变化有其规律……
Musae III: But not to worry! Just as a corrupted language still functions as a language, the core should still hold its basic cognitive properties. Perhaps you'll notice its shifting forms follow some kind of logic ...

尽管缪斯三世以轻缓的口吻和委婉的语调，发挥了它作为一位商人与一只毛绒玩偶所能发挥的全部安抚能力，乌尔里希和哑谜的脸色此刻仍然不太好看。
Even though Musae III speaks with all the soothing skills of both a businessman and a stuffed animal, neither Ulrich nor Enigma seems any more relaxed.

哑谜：所以我们要在几乎毫无情报的情况下，找一个会变形的“普罗透斯”。
Enigma: So what you're saying is we're hunting a "Proteus" with almost no leads?

缪斯三世：事实确实如此，亲爱的朋友……很遗憾我没有海豹皮给你们。另外——如果拉普拉斯的语言已经成了这个样子，玩具箱里棋子们的状况恐怕只会更糟。
Musae III: Precisely, my friend! I only wish I had some sealskins to give you. Ah, before I forget, if the language in Laplace has become this bad, things inside the toybox are probably even worse.

缪斯三世：你们还有转译器吗?
Musae III: Do you still have a translator?

众人看向始终保持沉默的 APPLe。这沉默和往常不同，似乎并非出于一位绅士的谦逊，而是出于某种令人尴尬的困境。
Everyone turns to look at APPLe, whose long silence now feels less like a gentleman's politeness and more like someone caught in an awkward situation.

APPLe：……窝这里还友最厚一个。
APPLe: ... I ... I has last wun.

缪斯三世：噢！那群黑色绒毛小家伙的语言。真有意思，这的确也称得上是一种符号系统。
Musae III: Interesting! He's speaking like one of those little black fuzzy creatures. I suppose Critter communication does qualify as some kind of symbolic system.

苹果表皮的色泽从未如此红润。它飞快地将转译器递给乌尔里希，细小的爪子与磁流体郑重交握。
The apple's skin has never looked so red. He quickly hands the translator to Ulrich.

APPLe：请尽筷把哎剖某从困镜中解酒出来吧，拜脱了，蓬友。
APPLe: Please, help this APPLe soon, my friend.

磁流体深深颤动了一下，这大概等同于人类的深呼吸，能在糟透了的状况中带来一点聊胜于无的自我宽慰。
The ferrofluid trembles deeply in its tank—probably the equivalent to a deep breath for a human—in an attempt to stay calm.

乌尔里希：好吧，转译器、“普罗透斯”、语言与认知紊乱……听起来和“暴雨”前的混乱没什么两样，不过至少我已经学会了怎么和棋子打交道。
Ulrich: Alright then. Translators, a "Proteus," language and cognitive disorders ... Sounds just like the chaos before the "Storm," but at least now I know how to deal with the pieces.

乌尔里希：我准备好了。
Ulrich: I'm ready.

哑谜：不，是我准备好了。
Enigma: No. I'M ready.

哑谜黑着脸上前一步。
Enigma steps forward, a dark look on his face.

哑谜：以防你不合时宜的人道主义精神再次复发，这次我来。
Enigma: Considering how humanitarianism seems to overtake you at the worst possible times, it's safer if I handle it this time.

【3.1】雨前漫游 02

[English text unavailable] COL-900002

哑谜： 所以整个拉普拉斯就想不出一个能把这个该死的箱子问题彻底解决的办法吗?
Enigma: So the whole of Laplace can't figure out how to fix this ridiculous box problem once and for all?

兔毛手袋： 嘿，别抱怨了阿德勒，有你的信。
Medicine Pocket: Quit your whining, Adler. Got a letter for you.

哑谜： 我的？这张破纸片，用的还是拉普拉斯通用的演算纸，你怎么就知道这是我的?
Enigma: For me? This just looks like a piece of regular Laplace calculation paper. What makes you think it's for me?

兔毛手袋： 问得太好了，第一点，这封信被夹在你门缝上的，第二点，有人用黑漆标注了一个大大的“看这里”。
Medicine Pocket: One, it was shoved into YOUR door. Two, there's a big "READ IT" written on it in black ink.

兔毛手袋翻了翻白眼，在它看来每做一件事都得解释一遍真的太麻烦了。
Medicine Pocket rolls their eyes at having to yet again spell things out.

兔毛手袋： 我很难想象除了投诉信，谁会用这么无聊的方式传纸条。
Medicine Pocket: Honestly, who does something like that unless it's some kind of complaint?

哑谜打开了纸条，那是一张很普通的拉普拉斯演算用纸，而上面的内容却一点都不普通。
Enigma unfolds what looks like a piece of regular Laplace calculation paper, but what's on it is clearly far from ordinary.

哑谜： 虽然不知道是谁写的，但是里面提到了让我修一座……塔。一座能统一箱中所有语言的信号塔。
Enigma: No name on it. They're proposing construction of some ... tower. A tower to standardize all linguistic systems inside the toybox.

冷周六： 这听起来像是什么神话故事。Bonjour，阿德勒研究员，不好意思又听到了你们的对话。不过我还是想问一句——除了我们谁还知道里面的东西丢了呢?
Hissabeth: Sounds like something from a detective novel. Hey, Adler—sorry for eavesdropping. But besides us, who else knows about the missing core?

哑谜： 太好了，我们的保密工作做得就像在楼下公开演讲。
Enigma: Perfect. Our security protocols might as well be town crier announcements.

兔毛手袋： 该死的，洛伦兹他们一定是闻着神秘学事故的怪味找上来的。
Medicine Pocket: It's gotta be Institutum Lorentz. They must've sniffed out info on our little "arcane accident" somehow.

哑谜： 可疑的奇怪结社，可是方法理论上确实可行，只要统一了语言就可以完美地解决现在所有的问题。
Enigma: As suspicious an institution as they are, their idea is theoretically feasible. Creating a unified language system, no matter what it is, would solve all our problems.

乌尔里希： 如果这封建议来自洛伦兹，他们为什么要帮助我们？……马库斯小姐，你能从这张纸片上看出些什么?
Ulrich: But what would Lorentz gain by helping us? Ms. Marcus, are you able to glean any information from this note?

哑谜将纸条递给女孩儿。
Enigma passes it to her.

马库斯注视着这张小小的纸片。字与句，这是最易读的形式，她总能从中提取许多信息，但现在……
Marcus looks down at the small piece of paper. Normally, words are easy for her to gather information from, but now ...

马库斯：唔……
Marcus: Hmm ...

女孩皱着眉头，露出困惑不解的神情。
Her brow furrows.

马库斯：这份笔迹很精巧，像机械一样，看起来是由看重形式、追求完美的人写下的……
Marcus: The handwriting is very precise, almost like a machine—typical of a perfectionist, or someone who likes order ...

马库斯：可是，书写者握笔的力度几乎是在涂鸦，说明，呃，那人的性格恰好与上个结论相反……？
Marcus: Yet the uneven pressure almost suggests some carelessness, which, well, contradicts my initial assessment ...

马库斯：书写目的为……没有目的？只是单纯的笔画组合……这不可能，我……我看不懂……
Marcus: The writing's purpose seems to be ... purposeless? Like they're just random ink marks ... That can't be correct. I ... I can't make sense of this ...

哑谜：我看就是他们自己也被语言异化搞坏了脑子，想快点解决这个病症，又或许——
Enigma: Clearly, they're suffering from the same language disorder. Either they're rushing to fix it, or —

兔毛手袋：只要有什么跟“暴雨”沾上边了，他们会像魔精一样冒出来。模拟的“暴雨”也算“暴雨”，至少它现在有明显的奇怪特征了。
Medicine Pocket: Whenever something even slightly connects to the "Storm," they show up in swarms like Critters. I guess even a simulated version counts to them, especially now that it's obviously showing anomalies.

哑谜：好吧，无论如何，我们现在要在箱子里修建一座通天的巨塔，然后把所有的人都笼罩在一种语言下。真是伟大。
Enigma: Regardless, our task now is to build a massive tower inside that box to somehow get everyone to speak the same language. Amazing.

看来他们又需要进行一次探险，但是好消息是他们至少知道自己需要做什么了。
It seems another trip into the toybox will be necessary. At least, this time, they know exactly what needs to be done.

乌尔里希：我会在外面为你提供支援的，阿德勒研究员。
Ulrich: I'll be sure to offer support from the outside, Researcher Adler.

哑谜：你现在能帮忙的就是给我们每人准备一顶安全帽，毕竟我们现在都要去箱子里建塔了。
Enigma: The best "support" you can offer us now is to get us all hard hats, since we'll all be in a construction zone soon.

哑谜：哦对，也别忘记准备你自己的，不过得大一点，一般的帽子你的玻璃脑袋可戴不上。
Enigma: Oh, and make sure to get an extra-extra-large one for yourself to fit over that fish tank of yours.

【3.1】雨前漫游 03

[English text unavailable] COL-900003

???: 他们真的做到了，我还以为会失败然后封存。看起来下次的线索还得提供得更隐蔽一些。
???: They actually pulled it off. I thought they'd fail and seal it away. Next time, I'll need to be more subtle with the clues.

???: 让我想想给洛伦兹的报告该怎么圆呢。
???: Now then ... how should I explain this in my report to Lorentz?

【3.4】雨前漫游 01

[English text unavailable] COL-900004

玩具箱内
In the "Toybox"

乌尔里希: 等一下，星锑研究员——
Ulrich: Wait a second, Researcher Regulus.

乌尔里希: 你说你要……做什么?
Ulrich: You say you're planning to do ... what now?

星锑: 完成我本周的第 232 与 233 项指标内容。
Regulus: Complete my 232nd and 233rd weekly performance indicators, obvs.

星锑: 完善我关于“光学神秘术在建筑防御体系中如何应用”的报告，并于五小时后准时找 37 讨论如何开展面向所有人的代数几何课程。
Regulus: You see, I've got to finish my report on "Applications of Optical Arcane Skills in Architectural Defense Systems," then meet with 37 in exactly five hours to discuss launching a universal algebraic geometry curriculum.

星锑: 这是你第三次问这个问题，乌尔里希组长，难道这是我们新的员工考核方式?
Regulus: This is the third time you've asked me this, Mr. Ulrich. This some kind of new employee evaluation protocol?

星锑: 之前那些逻辑解密和数字谜题呢?
Regulus: Can't believe I'm saying so, but I think I prefer the logic puzzles and mathematical riddles.

乌尔里希: ……指标？逻辑？数字?
Ulrich: Evaluation? Logic? Riddles?

乌尔里希: 星锑研究员?!
Ulrich: Researcher Regulus?!

乌尔里希: 你不是——你不是觉得它们枯燥吗?
Ulrich: But you said you found them all, what was it, "a crushing bore"?

星锑: 枯燥？我以为我们已经达成共识——
Regulus: A bore? Hadn't we reached a consensus—

星锑: 这是世界上最优美、最有助于我们高效工作的方式之一!
Regulus: There's nothing more rockin' in the world than thorough mathematical analysis!

办公室
Office

这份报告已近乎完成，只剩下最后一行结论仍是空白。
The report is nearly complete. Only the final line of conclusions remains blank.

磁流体略微焦躁地快速闪烁着，拿起笔又放下。
Agitated, the ferrofluid inside his head flickers rapidly. He picks up his pen, then sets it down again.

???：乌尔里希先生?
???: Mr. Ulrich?

灰头发少年脚步轻快地推门进来，很快意识到自己打断了磁流体的思绪。
The cheerful young man pushes the door open and enters with light steps, realizing too late that he's interrupted Ulrich's train of thought.

X：抱歉，你在忙？我可以等会儿再过来。
X: Sorry. Are you busy? I can come back later.

乌尔里希：不，我盯着这堆纸够久了。也许只要给它留一点儿私人时间，它就会承载我的意志觉醒为意识唤醒者，自己把自己完成。
Ulrich: No, I've been staring at this pile of paper long enough. Perhaps if I leave it alone long enough, it'll absorb some part of my arcane energy and become an Awakened that can write itself.

X 饶有兴致地眨着眼睛。
X blinks with interest.

X：说到这个，生物技术组的确曾有人想唤醒一个以“热爱工作”为意志的意识唤醒者，但是他们最后放弃了这项研究，因为他们猜想你就是。
X: On that particular topic, I think I remember someone in the biotechnology team once tried to create an Awakened that was entirely devoted to "loving work," but they abandoned the project after concluding that you were already the prime specimen.

X：我个人认为应该谨慎考虑重拾这项研究的决定，尤其是你，乌尔里希先生——这可能会引发意识唤醒者之间极为复杂的伦理问题。
X: I'd personally recommend exercising judicious foresight before reviving that particular study. Especially concerning you, Mr. Ulrich, it could trigger some extremely complex ethical questions between Awakened.

X：不过我很能理解这种心情。雨前漫游研究遇到了瓶颈?
X: Still, I empathize with the sentiment. Is the Pre-Storm research hitting a wall?

乌尔里希：……可以这么说。但出于权限原因，我不应该透露更多，希望你能理解，X 研究员。
Ulrich: You could say that. But I'm not authorized to say more. I hope you understand.

X：噢，实际上这才是我来找你的原因——我是来加入你们的，所以不用向我保密。
X: Oh, actually, that's precisely why I'm here. I'm joining your team. So, you don't need to dissemble any secrets from me.

X：我的申请。
X: My application.

X 递出手里的文件。
X hands him the document.

乌尔里希：雨前漫游装置……交互通讯系统的跟进研究?
Ulrich: Pre-Storm Wandering Device ... Interactive Communication System Follow-Up Research?

X：没错。在你前往南极时，我和兔毛手袋对玩具箱进行了一点儿“游戏版本升级”～
X: That's right. While you were in Antarctica, Medicine Pocket and I gave the toybox a little "version upgrade."

X：它现在支持接收其他人游玩时遗落的道具，还可以让大家进行一些游戏经验交流。
X: It can now pick up items other players drop during their runs, and it lets everyone share gameplay strategies.

乌尔里希：嘿！这是研究项目，不是动不动就更新的娱乐设施。
Ulrich: Hey! This is a research project, not some entertainment facility you can patch whenever you feel like it.

X：当然，让我更正我的措辞——出于科学严谨的研究态度与提高装置使用效率的研究目的，大家都很愿意利用私人娱乐时间为你们提供数据样本。
X: Of course, allow me to rephrase: out of rigorous scientific methodology and the goal of improving device efficiency, this system allows testers to contribute sample data during their personal recreation time.

X：总之，我认为这个交互系统很有潜力，值得进一步跟进，因此向哑谜先生提交了合作申请，并已经通过审批～
X: Anyway, I think this interactive system has real potential and merits further investigation. That's why I submitted a collaboration proposal to Mr. Enigma, and it's already been approved.

X：所以雨前研究遇到了什么问题?
X: So, what's going on with your Pre-Storm research?

乌尔里希：从南极回来后，我去查看了玩具箱内的情况……信号塔的落成让箱子发生了一些变化。
Ulrich: After I got back from Antarctica, I checked the interior of the toybox. Since the Language Tower was finished, things have changed in there.

磁流体将桌上的报告推给 X。
Ulrich slides the report across the table toward X.

X：“在最近几次模拟中，雨前漫游装置内已形成完整的‘暴雨’应对措施，能够在无人员伤亡的情况下高效开展风险防范、先期处置等工作。”
X: "In recent simulations, a complete 'Storm' response protocol has formed within the Pre-Storm Wandering Device, capable of efficiently executing risk prevention and preliminary response measures with zero casualties."

X：“观测期间，在无外力干扰的情况下，装置内‘暴雨’的度过率已达 100%。”
X: "During the observation period, with no external interference, the success rate for weathering the 'Storm' within the device has reached 100%."

X：嗯……各项数据看起来相当完美。
X: Hmm. The data looks impeccable.

X：这份报告足够完备，我相信它甚至能引起那些大人物的注意。你在为什么烦心?
X: This report should be thorough enough to capture the attention of the higher-ups. What's still bothering you?

乌尔里希：乌鸦——路德维希的棋子在里面建立起新秩序，而其他人似乎都被新秩序和信号塔的统一语言影响了思维。
Ulrich: The raven—Ludwig's piece—established a new order inside, and everyone else's thinking seems to have been influenced by the new order and the Language Tower.

乌尔里希：你能想象吗？我见到了热爱数学而非胡椒博士的星锑，放弃理线学转攻神秘学材料研究的北方哨歌，以及没有咬坏任何实验室设备的兔毛手袋……
Ulrich: Can you imagine? I encountered a Regulus who loved mathematics instead of Dr. Papper, a Windsong who abandoned the study of ley lines to focus on arcane material research, and a Medicine Pocket who hadn't chewed through a single piece of lab equipment.

乌尔里希：一切都按照指标和规划有条不紊地推进，所有员工都严格听从上级安排，将所有精力投入研究，并以最高效率办公。
Ulrich: Everything progresses smoothly according to indicators and schedules. Every employee strictly follows orders from above, devotes all their energy to research, and works at maximum efficiency.

X：听起来正常得有点疯狂。不过我以为你会更期待一个有序高效的拉普拉斯?
X: So, everyone is committed to their research and behaves rationally? It seems a little far-fetched, I admit. Though I thought you'd welcome a more orderly and efficient Laplace?

磁流体陷入沉默。
Ulrich falls silent.

X 耸耸肩，将报告放回原处。
X shrugs and sets the report back down.

X：我只是来向你同步合作消息的，并没有权限干涉研究，乌尔里希先生。
X: I'm just here to coordinate on the collaboration. I don't have clearance to interfere with the research, Mr. Ulrich.

X：就个人而言，我很期待你们的项目能顺利推进。这算是我私下对同事的祝福～
X: Personally, I hope your project goes well. Just consider it a colleague's private well-wishes.

X 很快离开，只留下被翻阅到最后一页的文件摊在桌上。
X leaves. The document lies open on the table, turned to its final page.

乌尔里希：……
Ulrich: ...

乌尔里希拿起笔，写下最后的结论。
Ulrich picks up the pen and writes down his final conclusion.

乌尔里希：……然而其参与者在不明原因作用下，悉数奉行效率至上、结果至上的行为模式，表现出缺乏人性，趋近机械化的思维。
Ulrich: However, for reasons unknown, all participants have adopted behavior patterns prioritizing efficiency and results above all else, exhibiting a worrisome lack of humanity and increasingly mechanized thinking.

乌尔里希：综上所述，不建议立即实行该雨前漫游措施，本《指南》可行性仍待进一步考察。
Ulrich: In conclusion, immediate implementation of this *Pre-Storm Protocol* is not recommended. The feasibility of this Protocol requires further evaluation.

会议室
Conference Room

缪斯三世：所以，这就是乌尔里希先生的观点。
Musae III: So, this is Mr. Ulrich's perspective.

缪斯三世：而哑谜先生则有一些不同见解。
Musae III: But Mr. Enigma has a different view.

冷周六：你的说法太客气了。
Hissabeth: You're putting it nicely.

兔毛手袋：他大吼乌尔里希的那一嗓子堪称扰民。
Medicine Pocket: All of that yelling he did at Ulrich was pretty disruptive, if entertaining.

X：听兔毛手袋说“扰民”这个词比我想象的还要有趣。
X: It's humorous to hear Medicine Pocket of all people use the word "disruptive."

不该出现在对话里的人似乎越来越多。
Their conversation has drawn in more than they initially expected.

哑谜捏了捏眉心，转过身来。
Enigma pinches the bridge of his nose and turns around.

哑谜：为什么你们还在这儿?
Enigma: Why are you all still here?

冷周六：是啊，X，为什么你在这儿?
Hissabeth: That's a good question. X, why are you here?

X：因为我向哑谜先生正式提交过申请，“编外人员”女士。
X: Because I've formally submitted my application to Mr. Enigma, "Ms. Volunteer."

冷周六：“编外”正体现了蛇发女妖们天生具备的，与同伴间的友爱与奉献精神。现在我们可是无偿劳动。
Hissabeth: Hmph. "Volunteer" perfectly reflects we Melusines' natural generosity and selfless spirit. Some of us don't need any incentive to help advance scientific progress.

兔毛手袋：有道理。我需要申请加班费。
Medicine Pocket: Oh yeah, that reminds me I need to clock my overtime hours.

冷周六：也可以折算成我们的研究经费。“编外”人员有“编外”资金，听起来很合理不是吗?
Hissabeth: Or redirect it to our research budget. "Volunteer" members should get their own special allocations. Reasonable, n'est-ce pas?

小蛇 I：合理！而且二号早就看过项目报告了，我们算特邀人员。
Snake I: Agreed! Besides, Two already read that report ages ago. We really should already count as being on the team.

一旁的磁流体立刻捕捉到关键词。
Ulrich catches on to something from the snake's statement.

乌尔里希：你看过报告？什么时候?
Ulrich: You read the report? When?

刚插了一句嘴就惹出麻烦的小蛇迅速缩回青蓝色发丝间。
Having accidentally stirred up trouble, the little snake retreats into Hissabeth's blue-green hair.

而蛇发女妖流畅地向旁边一指。
Hissabeth, slightly flustered, points a finger outward.

冷周六：兔毛手袋也看过报告。
Hissabeth: Medicine Pocket also read it.

乌尔里希：什么？为什么——
Ulrich: What? Why—

乌尔里希：说到这个，是谁把我的报告拿给阿德勒研究员的？我明明还没提交。
Ulrich: Speaking of which, who gave my report to Adler? I haven't even submitted it yet.

兔毛手袋：我需要最新数据去调试玩具箱的交互系统。嘿，是你自己没把办公室门锁好。
Medicine Pocket: I needed the latest data to tune the toybox's interactive system. Hey, you're the one who doesn't know how to lock your office door properly.

乌尔里希：这不可……所以你看完就提交给了阿德勒?
Ulrich: That's impossible. So you read it and then submitted it to Adler?

兔毛手袋：谁有那个闲工夫。我随手放在……
Medicine Pocket: Who has time for that? I just left it ...

它迟疑地啃咬着工牌。
They hesitate and chew on the ID card.

冷周六：放在你办公室窗边唯一的那个花盆里。
Hissabeth: In the pot by your office window, we think.

冷周六：五号出去玩时看见的。自从它得知玩具箱里出现过一条变来变去的蛇，就对箱子有关的事特别感兴趣。
Hissabeth: Alexandre spotted it when he went out to play. Ever since he learned there was a shape-shifting snake inside the toybox, he's been obsessed with anything related to it.

冷周六：顺便一提，那扇窗户实在没什么保密性可言。你该把它放在更不容易被别人拿走的地方。
Hissabeth: By the way, that window ledge has zero security. You really must put it somewhere less accessible.

乌尔里希：到底有多少人——还有蛇——看过我的报告?!
Ulrich: How many people, including snakes, have read my report?!

冷周六：你知道我们蛇发女妖是共享思维的对吧？除此之外我保证我没有外传。
Hissabeth: Well, of course, we Melusines share consciousness between all our snakes. But aside from that, we promise we haven't told anyone else.

X：而我是在上次去找你时浏览的，乌尔里希先生。
X: As you know, I read it during my last visit, Mr. Ulrich.

X 和冷周六一齐露出乖顺礼貌的微笑。
X and Hissabeth show identical meek, polite smiles.

哑谜：……好了。
Enigma: Enough.

代理负责人皱着眉打断了这场牵扯进越来越多人的指控。
The substitute director frowns and cuts off the spiraling accusations.

哑谜：总而言之，我看到了报告，并且不赞同乌尔里希的看法。
Enigma: Regardless, I've read the report, and I disagree with Ulrich.

哑谜：我们会再进一次箱子，分别提交报告，并想办法解决你那个核心的问题，狐狸。
Enigma: We'll enter the box again, submit separate reports, and try to solve that core problem of yours, Mr. Fox.

缪斯三世：那再好不过了，亲爱的朋友们!
Musae III: That's wonderful news, dear friends!

缪斯三世的两个头都露出愉快的神情，对发生在眼前的混乱毫不介意。
Both of Musae III's heads display cheerful expressions, totally unaware of the chaos around them.

缪斯三世：我这儿也有一个好消息。
Musae III: I also happen to have excellent news.

缪斯三世：我带来了你们需要的“海豹皮”!
Musae III: I've brought the sealskin you need!

哑谜：“海豹皮”……抓住多变之神普罗透斯的关键?
Enigma: Sealskin? The key to capturing Proteus, the shape-shifting god?

缪斯三世：没错!
Musae III: Spot on, old chap!

缪斯三世：“披上海豹皮，抓住那个善变的神灵，不管他变成蛇、雄鸡、树还是流水。”
故事是这样讲的，对吧?
Musae III: "Don the sealskin and seize that shape-shifting god, be he snake, rooster, tree, or flowing water." That's how the story goes, right?

缪斯三世：当你们拿到核心，这件稳固装置会自动把核心收纳并固定为单一稳定形态。
Musae III: Once you obtain the core, this stabilization device will cause it to adopt a single stable form.

缪斯三世：这样你们就不必担心因为分散注意而再次丢失核心，或是被那些眼花缭乱的变化搞坏脑子啦！
Musae III: That way, you needn't have to worry about losing it again through distraction or having those dizzying transformations scramble your brains!

哑谜：它还会搞坏我们的脑子？
Enigma: It can scramble our brains?

缪斯三世：我保证现在绝对不会。
Musae III: Not anymore! I can practically guarantee that.

狐狸玩偶笑眯眯地调试好玩具箱，语气热络如一位向孩子们推销过夜蛋糕试吃的店主。
The fox plushie adjusts the toybox with a smile, his tone as inviting as it is oddly sinister.

缪斯三世：所以，朋友们，谁想要第一个进去？
Musae III: So, friends, who'd like to do the honors?

【3.4】雨前漫游 02

[English text unavailable] COL-900005

巨塔在面前崩毁。
The tower collapses.

玩具箱内
In the "Toybox"

“起义”的人们在身后欢呼，受统治的员工们开始发出在正常拉普拉斯环境中常能听见的大呼小叫。
The crowd roars behind them, as the newly freed employees begin letting out their usual cheers.

乌鸦跌落在地面上，深一脚浅一脚地绕了两圈，开始扇动翅膀。
The raven crashes to the ground, staggers in uneven circles twice, then starts flapping its wings.

乌尔里希：嘿！那只疯乌鸦！阿德勒！
Ulrich: Hey! Crazy raven! Adler!

哑谜这次反应迅速。
Enigma reacts quickly this time.

他飞身一扑，成功将乌鸦在飞走前截住。
He lunges forward and catches the bird before it can fly away.

鸟类棋子在人类棋子的圆筒身子底下翻滚，试图从两根细棍手臂的压制下逃脱。
The bird piece tumbles beneath the cylindrical human's, struggling to escape the grip of two stick arms.

两枚棋子能做出的动作都非常有限，场面一时间僵持不下。
Neither piece can move freely. The struggle continues.

哑谜：乌尔里希——过来——帮忙！
Enigma: Ulrich—come—help!

乌尔里希：我不认为再叠一个圆筒上去除了会使这一切更像马戏表演外，还有什么其他作用。
Ulrich: Stacking another cylinder on top will accomplish nothing besides making this look even more like a circus act.

哑谜：X 说——他有异常的——数据——波动——
Enigma: X says—he's detecting—abnormal—data fluctuations—

哑谜：至少弄明白——
Enigma: At least figure out—

乌尔里希： 小心！
Ulrich: Watch out!

不要在危墙前面逗留打闹，更不要在一座正崩毁的巨塔前。每个人都该牢记这点。
Don't linger in front of a crumbling wall, much less a collapsing tower. Everyone should remember that.

一根金属棍直直坠下，砸在乌鸦的脑壳上。
A metal rod falls and strikes the raven on the head.

乌鸦棋子： 嘎！
Crow Piece: Gah!

……

...

乌尔里希： 他死了？
Ulrich: Is he dead?

哑谜： 没有。大概被砸晕了。
Enigma: No. Likely concussed, but alive.

哑谜： 不，等等，他……
Enigma: No, wait, he ...

哑谜从地上起身，另一枚棋子的模样显露出来。
Enigma rises from the floor, revealing the other piece's appearance.

他瘫软的肢体正迅速变得僵直笔挺，两只翅膀不自然地呈“T”字型打开，就好像中了瞬时石化咒，或者……
His limp body stiffens as his wings spread in a sharp unnatural pose as if struck by a Stono Swift, or ...

变回了一枚没有意识、不会自主行动的、真正的棋子。
Reverting to an unconscious, immobile, genuine game piece.

乌尔里希： 数据错误？箱子里的棋子从来没有这种形态。
Ulrich: Is this a bug? The pieces in the box have never taken this form.

哑谜： X?
Enigma: X?

X 的声音远远地从头顶传来。
X's voice drifts down from overhead.

X： 我在。箱子中的异常神秘术波动消失了。
X: I'm here. The abnormal arcane fluctuation has dissipated.

哑谜： 回去再说。先搞定核心。
Enigma: We'll deal with that later. We must secure the core first.

两人重新看向高塔。
They turn their attention back to the tower.

在两双眼睛的注视下，倒塌的塔身连带着那根金属棍一齐变形，转变为一沓实验报告。
Under their gaze, the collapsed tower, along with that metal rod, transforms together into a stack of research reports.

乌尔里希： 我的报告？不对，是平衡伞。兔毛的盆栽……仓鼠球。为什么是仓鼠球?
Ulrich: My report? No, it's the Equilibrium Umbrella. Medicine Pocket's plant, or a hamster ball. Why a hamster ball?

哑谜：别盯着它！
Enigma: Don't stare at it!

各种形态在眼前融化又重组。
Various forms melt and reshape themselves before their eyes.

强忍着太阳穴的阵阵胀痛，哑谜迅速掏出固定装置，贴向目前已变成壁球球拍的核心。
Fighting through the throbbing pain in his temples, Enigma pulls out the stabilization device and thrusts it up against the core, which now resembles a squash racket.

现在，它是一团……
Now it's a blob of ...

乌尔里希：液态金属？
Ulrich: Liquid metal?

哑谜：看着像你的兄弟。
Enigma: It could be your brother.

乌尔里希：不会再有上次示波器那事儿了，我百分百确定，它绝对不是意识唤醒者。
Ulrich: This isn't like that incident with the oscilloscope. I'm one hundred percent certain: this is not an Awakened.

哑谜：真高兴我们可以省去你对它用各种语言打招呼的时间。但既然你提到了——
Enigma: Then we'll skip greeting it in every language you know. But since you brought it up—

哑谜：也许它和示波器一样保存着某种加密数据。
Enigma: It's possible that it stores encrypted data like the oscilloscope did.

哑谜：走了，把它拿出去看看。
Enigma: Let's go. We'll take it outside and examine it.

哑谜：作为支撑整个玩具箱运转的核心，它总不能只是一架摆着好看的万花筒。
Enigma: The core sustains the entire toybox. This can't simply be some mere decorative kaleidoscope.

拉普拉斯某房间
Laplace

X：是吗？我以为这只是一架和路德维希先生有点儿关系的万花筒。
X: Are you certain? I thought it had some tenuous connection to Mr. Ludwig.

???：你上次还报告说它是 Z 女士送来的。你不怀疑它有其他隐秘用途？
???: Your last report stated it was delivered by Madam Z. Don't you worry it may have other purposes?

X：Z 女士一向关注“暴雨”相关的研究选题，她主动请玩具商送来一个模拟“暴雨”的装置，这件事并不让人意外。
X: Madam Z has always been interested in "Storm"-related research. It's not surprising she'd ask the Toymaker to bring a "Storm" simulation device.

X：“玩具箱”只有两处异常——路德维希先生的波动，以及装置损坏后出现的类似暴雨症候的语言异化症。
X: The toybox displays two anomalies: Mr. Ludwig's arcane fluctuation and post-damage symptoms resembling the Language Deviation Syndrome.

X：由于路德维希先生本就与语言学研究有关，我建议总部以他为切入口跟进。
X: Given that Mr. Ludwig's field of research involves linguistic analysis, I recommend the headquarters pursue leads through him.

X：如今箱中波动消失，当务之急应该是继续寻找路德维希先生的相关线索。
X: Now that the fluctuation inside the box has vanished, the priority should be continuing our search for information related to Mr. Ludwig.

X：——情报，以及个人猜想，我向总部汇报时可没有任何隐瞒。
X: Including any intelligence and theories. Of course, I won't conceal anything relevant from the headquarters.

???：呵呵，当然——你的汇报一向很“及时”。
???: Heh, naturally, your reports are always so "timely."

???：我只是来告诉你，总部近期可能有所动作。玩得开心。
???: I'm simply informing you that the headquarters may make a move soon. Enjoy yourself.

X：没问题。
X: Understood.

少年挂断通讯，房间里重归安静，只剩下他自己的呼吸声。
The young man ends the call. The room falls quiet again, except for the rise and fall of his breath.

风暴尚未到来……何况远方的飓风很难牵扯到停于此处的蝴蝶。
The "Storm" has yet to arrive. Besides, a distant hurricane would hardly affect a butterfly at rest here.

他迈着与往日无二的轻快步伐走了出去。
He walks out with the same light steps as always.

哑谜办公室
Enigma's Office

露西：听说你与乌尔里希先生已分别提交《雨前紧急状况应对指南》，祝贺你们取得成果。
Lucy: I understand that you and Mr. Ulrich have each submitted your own *Pre-Storm Emergency Protocols*. Congratulations on your progress.

哑谜：……谢谢您。您近来如何?
Enigma: Thank you. How have you been?

露西：我仍在执行“休息”这一任务，并已通过多种渠道收集到与该词条相关的 38742 条行为数据。
Lucy: I continue to execute my assigned task of "resting" and have collected 38,742 pieces of behavioral data related to this term through various channels.

露西：目前我正通过列出的排期规划表格，逐一实践相关行为。根据周围人的反馈，我的执行效果虽然偶有偏差，但总体而言符合预期。
Lucy: Currently I am practicing these relevant behaviors according to my scheduled itinerary. Based on feedback from those around me, while my execution occasionally deviates, the overall outcome meets expectations.

露西：“于度假期间致电以往同事，炫耀自己假期行程，并享受对方对工作的抱怨”在今日的“休息”事项清单上，这也是我与你通讯的原因。
Lucy: "Call former colleagues during vacation, boast about holiday plans, and relish their work-related complaints" is on today's "resting" checklist. As you might infer, that includes you.

露西：现在，希望你能配合我完成这一任务，开始你的“抱怨”。
Lucy: Now, please assist me in completing this task by airing any "gripes" or "complaints" you may have.

哑谜：……
Enigma: ...

哑谜： 您还是这么……具有您的风范。真好。
Enigma: You're still so very ... you. How wonderful.

哑谜： 该怎么说呢。我……
Enigma: How do I put this? I ...

哑谜： 我对玩具箱核心的研究还没有丝毫头绪，等待审批的文件比乌尔里希的假期余额还多，而拉普拉斯……
Enigma: I still have zero leads on the toybox core research. Files awaiting approval outnumber Ulrich's remaining vacation days. And Laplace ...

哑谜忽然摇了摇头，不再继续。
He shakes his head and stops.

哑谜： 这些是我要去处理的，不该在您这里继续抱怨了。
Enigma: These are matters I need to handle myself. I shouldn't be complaining to you.

哑谜： 希望您的“休息计划”顺利完成。
Enigma: Best of luck with your "rest program."

露西： 很高兴听到你对我当前任务的认可。
Lucy: I am pleased you approve of my current task.

露西女士在通讯器里点点头，人造的双眼透过电子屏幕注视着这位曾经的下属。
Madam Lucy nods through the communicator, her artificial eyes observing her former subordinate through the screen.

露西： 据我所知，拉普拉斯在员工关怀方面一向秉持人性化理念。
Lucy: To my knowledge, Laplace has always upheld the highest principles of humanitarianism when it comes to employee welfare.

露西： 如果你感到疲惫，可以考虑申请休假，进行适当疗养。
Lucy: If you are feeling fatigued, you should apply for leave and pursue appropriate rest.

露西： 我对于疗养地点选取与度假方式已颇有心得，欢迎你随时与我交流。
Lucy: I have gained considerable expertise in selecting ideal destinations and recuperation methods. You are welcome to consult with me at any time.

哑谜： ……谢谢。
Enigma: ... Thank you.

哑谜： 我会的。
Enigma: I just might.

机器人愉快地眨了眨眼睛。
The robot blinks cheerfully.

露西： 那么，我该去筹备清单的下一项——“溜进休假前工作场所，进行随机恶作剧并等待‘惊喜一刻’”了。
Lucy: Well then, I must prepare for the next item on my list: "Sneak into pre-vacation workplace, execute random pranks, and await the 'moment of surprise.'"

露西： 再见，哑谜先生。
Lucy: Goodbye, Mr. Enigma.

哑谜： 再见，露西女——
Enigma: Goodbye, Madam Luc—

哑谜： 等等，嘿，别挂，您刚刚说什么?!
Enigma: Wait, hold on, don't hang up! What did you just say?!